

SCRUM LEADERSHIP SERIES

Product Ownership I: Learning Objectives

Seventeen modules. Each module maps directly to one chapter of Product Ownership I: Leading a Team. These objectives are used to demonstrate understanding for the Recognized Product Owner 1 credential.

The domain of practice and a Practice Partner are part of the learning.

These objectives are not met by recognizing the language or repeating an accepted explanation. The book and the course must be coupled with the learner's domain of practice, where actual conditions, constraints, and evidence give the objectives meaning.

Every learner works with a Practice Partner: another learner, a practitioner within the learner's domain, or a 3Back Expert Echo. For each significant objective, learners explain it in their own words, connect it to actual work, question one another's accounts, test assumptions and competing explanations, and identify the evidence that would support or challenge their conclusions.

The Practice Partner makes the learner's reasoning visible and correctable. The facilitator provides guidance and calibration, but cannot supply the learner's domain experience or establish professional capability for them. Capability develops through repeated judgment, action, and evidence in the work.

Learning approach: This document applies the learning model described in *How 3Back Approaches Learning*, 3Back, September 2026.

3back.com/papers/how-3back-approaches-learning

MODULE 01

Scrum in a Nutshell

- 1.1 Explain Scrum as Teams using agility to develop Products in a complex environment.
- 1.2 Describe the Product Owner as the Team Member accountable for the value of Results.
- 1.3 Explain how the Product Owner orders the Backlog toward a Product Goal.
- 1.4 Describe Sprint Planning as agreeing a Sprint Goal and a Sprint Backlog.
- 1.5 Outline why the Product Review exists to get Stakeholder feedback on Done Results.

MODULE 02

The Scrum Team

- 2.1 Identify Team Member, Product Owner, and Scrum Master as the on-Team roles.
- 2.2 Distinguish Business Owner, Stakeholder, and Subject Matter Expert as outside roles.
- 2.3 Explain why the Team must be self-contained and self-organized, yet not self-directed.
- 2.4 Describe the seven Team Values the book asks Team Members to live.
- 2.5 Explain why the Product Owner is a Team Member, not a customer sitting outside the Team.

MODULE 03

The Team's Product Owner

- 3.1 State that Product Owner accountability for value cannot be shared.
- 3.2 Explain the deal: the Product Owner tells the Team what to work on and owns the Results.
- 3.3 Describe the Product Owner as the Team Member with final say over what the Team does.
- 3.4 Explain why the Business Owner and Stakeholders must respect that final say.
- 3.5 Describe the Scrum Master's job of facilitating the Team's relationship with its Product Owner.
- 3.6 Identify what goes wrong when the Organization wants a Product Owner with no authority.

MODULE 04**People Outside The Team**

- 4.1 Distinguish the Business Owner, Stakeholder, and Subject Matter Expert roles.
- 4.2 Compare Product Owner alone, paired with a Business Owner, and in a hierarchy.
- 4.3 Explain why only the Team Product Owner may change Team priorities.
- 4.4 Describe the Business Owner as the person the Product Owner is officially accountable to.
- 4.5 Apply the Buddy-Up pattern so a Team Member stays accountable when a SME helps.
- 4.6 Keep Stakeholders from directing Team Members around the Product Owner.

MODULE 05**Leadership**

- 5.1 Define the Team Captain as the member accountable to Stakeholders for Team results.
- 5.2 Contrast managing and directing with the book's idea of real Leadership.
- 5.3 Describe Emergent Leadership as informal leadership that arises as needed.
- 5.4 Explain why the Team Captain keeps accountability and does not blame the Team.
- 5.5 Use shared How decisions so trust and respect can grow between Team and Team Captain.

MODULE 06**What is 'Product'?**

- 6.1 Explain why Product and Work Results are not obvious even on a software Team.
- 6.2 Describe Product as valuable Results the Team can get to Done for Stakeholders.
- 6.3 Distinguish deliverable Product from other Results the Team still owes the Business.
- 6.4 Identify who judges whether a Result is valuable enough to keep.

MODULE 07**The Backlog**

- 7.1 Describe the Backlog as Team-owned work used to select work and inform Stakeholders.
- 7.2 Explain that any Stakeholder may add an Item while only the Product Owner orders work.
- 7.3 Distinguish Freezer, Fridge, Back Burner, and Front Burner levels of the Backlog.
- 7.4 Keep the Back Burner small so Ready Stories stay inventory rather than waste.
- 7.5 Track Epic quotas so Stakeholders can see Done work, progress, Ready work, and out-of-scope work.

MODULE 08**Capabilities and Chores**

- 8.1 Distinguish Capabilities that give value to Stakeholders from Chores that serve Team or Product.
- 8.2 Explain Business Value as the value a Capability produces for people outside the Team.
- 8.3 Describe why Chores still belong on the Backlog and still need a Product Owner decision.
- 8.4 Order Capabilities and Chores together rather than running a secret second backlog.
- 8.5 Identify Risks and Issues as Items that may sit beside Capabilities in the Backlog.

MODULE 09**Stories and Epics**

- 9.1 Define a Story as a small, well-defined Item the Team can agree to and get to Done.
- 9.2 Define an Epic as a large, ambiguous Item that usually matters more to Stakeholders.
- 9.3 Explain why Stakeholders care about Capability Epics, Risks, and Issues more than Stories.
- 9.4 Describe extracting Stories from an Epic before the work can go to Planning.
- 9.5 Explain why a Story is the unit of work and an Epic is not something the Team Swarms as one lump.

MODULE 10**Technical Debt (short)**

- 10.1 Define Technical Debt as work that meets Acceptance Criteria but not the Standard of Care.
- 10.2 Explain why software Technical Debt stays with the Team after delivery.
- 10.3 Describe Clean Code as code the Team is not afraid to change.
- 10.4 Explain the Product Owner's role in preferring prevention of Debt over mere feature count.

MODULE 11**The Story's Definition of Done**

- 11.1 Explain the Definition of Done as what the Team actually agreed to try in the Sprint.
- 11.2 Separate Acceptance Criteria, the right thing, from Standard of Care, the right way.
- 11.3 Describe a Definition of Done for coding, analysis, infrastructure, and research Stories.
- 11.4 Describe how an Epic's Definition of Done differs from a small Story's.
- 11.5 Use the Definition of Done as the contract that lets the Team own its effort.
- 11.6 Split a Story when the Team cannot yet own what Done means.

MODULE 12**Velocity, Size, and Effort**

- 12.1 Explain why Velocity, Size, and Effort sit outside the Scrum framework.
- 12.2 Distinguish work that provides Velocity from work that provides Value without Velocity.
- 12.3 Describe how Environmental Variables make Sprint Backlog estimates unreliable.
- 12.4 Explain why a Sprint Goal's wiggle room protects the Team better than a locked Sprint Backlog.

MODULE 13**Backlog Refinement**

- 13.1 Define Ready as a Story that needs less than a 10 minute discussion in Planning.
- 13.2 Extract Stories from Epics and draft Definitions of Done before Planning.
- 13.3 Compare Refinement Sessions with Refinement Stories as ways to prepare work.
- 13.4 Contrast Continuous Improvement, Defined Feature Delivery, and Fuzzy Feature Delivery.
- 13.5 Prioritize using business value, architectural significance, dependencies, and people availability.
- 13.6 Limit Back Burner refinement so unused Ready work does not become waste.

MODULE 14**Planning Day**

- 14.1 Sequence Product Review, Retrospective, Progress Assessment, and Sprint Planning on Planning Day.
- 14.2 Limit the Product Review to Done Results and Stakeholder product feedback.
- 14.3 Use the Retrospective to protect working practices, live Values, and select a Kaizen.
- 14.4 Describe the Product Owner's role in Planning Day without turning it into a status meeting.
- 14.5 Explain why Velocity-based Planning is no longer the recommended pattern in this book.

MODULE 15**Agreement-Based Planning**

- 15.1 Describe Agreement-Based Planning as agreeing Stories one by one until the Sprint is full.
- 15.2 Explain why the Product Owner must stay in Planning from start to finish.
- 15.3 Select a Kaizen and a Sprint Goal before locking a pile of Stories.
- 15.4 Explain why the Sprint Goal supplies wiggle room instead of locking the Sprint Backlog.
- 15.5 Forecast Stories as try-to-do work, not as a promise of scope.
- 15.6 Contrast Agreement-Based Planning with planning from Velocity and Capacity numbers.

MODULE 16**The Daily Scrum**

- 16.1 Explain the Daily Scrum as a daily inspect and adapt point, not a status meeting.
- 16.2 Include the Product Owner as a Team Member in the Daily Scrum.
- 16.3 Keep adaptations from changing the committed Sprint Goal.
- 16.4 Use Daily Scrum information to reopen scope talks with the Product Owner when needed.

MODULE 17**Scaling An Organization**

- 17.1 Define Scaling as Structure and Governance changes that enable growth.
- 17.2 Describe what happens to Product Ownership when a Team splits or a layer is added.
- 17.3 Explain why only one Product Owner on a Team still holds when the Organization grows.
- 17.4 Identify the risk of Stakeholders going around the Team Product Owner during growth.

3Back delivers Product Ownership I. RPO1 is recognized by the Scrum Guide Organization. These objectives follow Product Ownership I: Leading a Team by Dan Rawsthorne and Doug Shimp.